Class 6 Social Science – Chapter 10

Grassroots Democracy – Part 1: Governance

इस अध्याय के सभी मुख्य प्रश्नों के उत्तर simple English में दिए गए हैं। इसमें पाठ के विषयवार महत्वपूर्ण प्रश्न, गतिविधियों के नमूना उत्तर, परिभाषाएँ और परीक्षा की तैयारी के लिए अतिरिक्त प्रश्न भी शामिल हैं।

Part 1: Answers to the Big Questions

Q1. What is the meaning of governance?

Answer: Governance is the process of making decisions, implementing rules and managing public affairs. It helps society function smoothly and ensures that public services are provided to people.

Q2. Why do we need a government?

Answer: We need a government to maintain law and order, protect people's rights, provide public services, make laws, settle disputes and work for the welfare of the country.

Q3. What is the meaning of democracy? Why is it important?

Answer: Democracy means the rule of the people. In a democracy, people elect their representatives to make decisions on their behalf. It is important because it gives citizens a voice in government and helps protect their rights and freedoms.

Part 2: Answers to “Let’s Explore” Activities

A. Why Do We Need Governance? (Pages 150–152)

Q1. What problems might arise if there were no rules or governance?

Answer: There could be disorder, conflicts and unfair treatment. Public services might not work properly, and people might find it difficult to protect their rights or solve common problems.

Q2. Identify the public services shown in the pictures on page 152. What role does the government play in them?

Answer: Public services may include education, healthcare, transport, roads, water supply, sanitation, electricity, communication and security. The government makes policies, creates rules, provides funds and supervises these services to meet public needs.

Q3. Can you name other areas of daily life where the government plays an important role?

Answer: The government plays an important role in running schools and hospitals, maintaining roads, protecting forests, controlling pollution, managing public transport and providing emergency services.

B. The Three Organs of Government (Pages 153–154)

Q4. What might happen if all three organs of government were controlled by the same group of people?

Answer: The same group could make laws, implement them and decide whether its own actions were legal. This could lead to misuse of power and unfair decisions. The separation of powers helps prevent such problems.

Q5. How do the three organs work together to deal with cybercrime?

Answer:

- Legislature: Makes laws against cybercrime.
- Executive: Enforces these laws and investigates offences.
- Judiciary: Examines cases, decides whether the law has been broken and gives judgments.

This example shows how the three organs perform different but connected roles.

C. Three Levels of Government (Pages 155–156)

Q6. What are the three levels of government in India?

Answer: The three levels are:

1. Local government — village, town or city level.
2. State government — state level.
3. Central or Union government — national level.

Q7. Which level of government should deal with a small flood in a village?

Answer: The local authorities may deal with a small flood if they have enough resources. If the flood affects many towns and villages, the State Government may step in. A very large disaster may also require help from the Central Government.

Q8. Which government functions affect your daily life the most?

Answer: Education, public health, roads, clean drinking water, sanitation, transport and public safety affect my daily life the most. These services may involve local, State and Central governments.

Q9. How do adults interact with the government?

Answer: Adults may interact with the local government to obtain certificates or report sanitation problems, with the State Government for education or healthcare services, and with the Central Government for services such as passports or national identity-related matters.

D. Democracy and Elections (Pages 159–160)

Q10. What is the difference between direct democracy and representative democracy?

Answer: In direct democracy, people take part directly in making a decision, such as voting by a show of hands in a classroom. In representative democracy, people elect representatives who make decisions on their behalf.

Q11. Who can vote in Indian elections?

Answer: Indian citizens who are at least 18 years old can generally register as voters, subject to the legal requirements for voter registration.

Q12. What is grassroots democracy?

Answer: Grassroots democracy is a system that encourages ordinary citizens to participate in decisions affecting their lives. It gives people a voice at the local level and helps them take part in public affairs.

Q13. Why is voting important in a democracy?

Answer: Voting allows citizens to choose their representatives and express their preferences. It helps make the government accountable to the people.

Part 3: Answers to the End-of-Chapter Questions (Page 161)

Q1. What is the meaning of democracy? What is the difference between direct democracy and representative democracy?

Answer: Democracy means the rule of the people.

- Direct democracy: People directly take part in making a decision. For example, students voting to choose a picnic destination.
- Representative democracy: People elect representatives who make decisions on their behalf. India follows representative democracy at the State and national levels.

Q2. Recall the three organs of government. What are their different roles?

Answer: The three organs of government are:

1. Legislature: Makes, changes or removes laws.
2. Executive: Implements laws and runs the administration.
3. Judiciary: Interprets laws, settles disputes and gives judgments.

They have different responsibilities and work together to maintain good governance.

Q3. Why do we need three tiers of government?

Answer: We need three tiers because different problems require action at different levels. Local governments deal with local issues, State governments handle matters affecting the state, and the Central Government deals with national matters. This arrangement helps manage the country more effectively.

Q4. During the COVID-19 lockdown, what actions were taken? Which levels and organs of government were involved?

Answer: During the COVID-19 pandemic, governments took several steps to protect public health and manage the emergency. These included lockdowns, public health guidelines, testing, treatment, vaccination, the supply of essential goods and public awareness campaigns.

- Central Government: Issued national guidelines, coordinated the national response and supported vaccine development and supply.
- State Governments: Managed hospitals, public health services, testing and implementation of guidelines within their states.
- Local Governments: Helped with local awareness, sanitation, identifying local needs and distributing assistance.
- Legislature: Provided the legal framework and exercised its law-making and oversight roles.
- Executive: Implemented restrictions, coordinated public services and managed emergency measures.
- Judiciary: Heard cases related to rights, government actions and access to essential services.

The exact responsibilities varied over time and between different situations.

Part 4: Important Questions and Answers from Every Topic

Topic 1: Governance and Government

Q1. What is governance?

Answer: Governance is the process of making decisions and managing public affairs according to rules and policies.

Q2. What is a government?

Answer: A government is the system or group of institutions that makes laws, implements them and manages the affairs of a country or region.

Q3. Why is governance necessary?

Answer: Governance is necessary to maintain order, deliver public services, solve common problems, protect rights and ensure that society functions smoothly.

Q4. What is the difference between government and governance?

Answer: Government refers to the institutions and people that exercise public authority. Governance refers to the process by which decisions are made and implemented.

Q5. Name some important functions of a government.

Answer: A government makes laws, maintains law and order, protects the country, provides public services, manages public funds and works for people's welfare.

Topic 2: The Three Organs of Government

Q6. Name the three organs of government.

Answer: The legislature, executive and judiciary.

Q7. What is the legislature?

Answer: The legislature is the organ of government that makes, changes and removes laws.

Q8. What is the executive?

Answer: The executive is the organ that implements laws, carries out policies and runs the administration.

Q9. What is the judiciary?

Answer: The judiciary is the organ that interprets laws, settles disputes and decides cases according to law.

Q10. Why should the three organs have different roles?

Answer: Different roles help prevent the misuse of power. They allow the organs to perform their duties and provide checks on one another.

Q11. What is the difference between the legislature and the executive?

Answer: The legislature makes laws, while the executive implements them and manages government administration.

Q12. What is the difference between the executive and the judiciary?

Answer: The executive implements laws and government policies. The judiciary interprets laws and decides legal disputes.

Topic 3: Central and State Governments

Q13. What is the Central Government?

Answer: The Central or Union Government is responsible for governing the country at the national level.

Q14. Name some subjects handled by the Central Government.

Answer: Defence, foreign affairs, currency, atomic energy, communications, inter-state commerce and national policies are examples.

Q15. What is the State Government?

Answer: The State Government manages public affairs within a particular state.

Q16. Name some subjects handled by State Governments.

Answer: Police, law and order, public health, agriculture, irrigation, education and the implementation of laws within the state are examples.

Q17. Who is the nominal head of the Central Government? Who is its executive head?

Answer: The President of India is the nominal head of the Union executive. The Prime Minister heads the government and leads the executive in its day-to-day functioning.

Q18. Who is the nominal head of a State Government? Who is its executive head?

Answer: The Governor is the nominal head of the state executive. The Chief Minister heads the state government and leads its day-to-day functioning.

Q19. What are MPs and MLAs?

Answer:

- MP: Member of Parliament, elected to represent people in Parliament.
- MLA: Member of the Legislative Assembly, elected to represent people in a State Legislative Assembly.

Q20. What is the role of Parliament?

Answer: Parliament discusses national issues, makes laws on matters within its authority, approves government spending and holds the Union Government accountable.

Q21. What is a State Legislative Assembly?

Answer: A State Legislative Assembly is an elected body that discusses state matters, makes laws on subjects within its authority and holds the State Government accountable.

Topic 4: The Judiciary

Q22. Why is the judiciary important?

Answer: The judiciary protects the rule of law, settles disputes, interprets laws and helps protect people's rights.

Q23. Name the highest courts at the national and state levels.

Answer: The Supreme Court of India is the highest court at the national level. A High Court is the highest court at the state level, subject to the constitutional arrangement for states and shared High Courts.

Q24. How does the judiciary help maintain justice?

Answer: It hears cases, examines evidence, applies the law fairly and gives judgments. It can also review whether government actions follow the Constitution and the law.

Topic 5: Three Tiers of Government

Q25. What are the three tiers of government in India?

Answer: Local, State and Central governments.

Q26. What is local government?

Answer: Local government manages public affairs at the village, town or city level. It deals with local needs and problems.

Q27. Give examples of local issues.

Answer: Local roads, streetlights, drainage, waste management, local water supply and cleanliness are examples of local issues.

Q28. Why is it useful to divide responsibilities among three levels?

Answer: It allows decisions to be made at the level best suited to handle them. Local problems can be addressed locally, while larger problems can be managed by State or Central authorities.

Q29. How do the three levels cooperate during a disaster?

Answer: Local authorities respond to immediate needs. State authorities coordinate help across affected areas, while the Central Government may provide additional resources and national support when needed.

Topic 6: Democracy

Q30. What is the origin of the word democracy?

Answer: The word comes from two Greek words: dēmos, meaning “people”, and kratos, meaning “rule” or “power”.

Q31. What is representative democracy?

Answer: Representative democracy is a system in which people elect representatives to make decisions and govern on their behalf.

Q32. Why is India called a representative democracy?

Answer: India is called a representative democracy because citizens elect representatives to Parliament and State Legislative Assemblies, who discuss public issues and make laws.

Q33. What is universal adult suffrage?

Answer: Universal adult suffrage means that adult citizens have the right to vote, subject to the legal conditions for voting. In India, the voting age is 18 years.

Q34. What is voting?

Answer: Voting is the process by which people express their choice between candidates or options.

Q35. How does democracy protect people's interests?

Answer: Democracy allows people to choose their representatives, express their views, question the government and participate in public decisions.

Topic 7: Grassroots Democracy

Q36. What is grassroots democracy?

Answer: Grassroots democracy encourages ordinary citizens to participate in decisions that affect their lives, especially at the local level.

Q37. Why is grassroots democracy important?

Answer: It gives people a voice in local matters, encourages participation, helps identify local needs and makes public decision-making more responsive.

Q38. How can students practise democracy in school?

Answer: Students can elect class representatives, discuss issues respectfully, vote on suitable decisions, listen to different opinions and follow decisions reached fairly.

Q39. What is the importance of discussion and debate in democracy?

Answer: Discussion and debate help people share ideas, understand different viewpoints and find solutions to common problems.

Q40. What is the difference between grassroots democracy and representative democracy?

Answer: Grassroots democracy focuses on the participation of ordinary people, particularly in local decisions. Representative democracy works through elected representatives who make decisions on behalf of citizens. They can support each other.

Part 5: Important Definitions

Term	Meaning in simple English
Governance	The process of making decisions and managing public affairs
Government	Institutions that govern a country or region
Democracy	Rule of the people
Legislature	The organ that makes laws
Executive	The organ that implements laws
Judiciary	The organ that interprets laws and settles disputes
Election	A process through which people choose representatives
Voting	Expressing a choice in an election or decision
Representative	A person chosen to speak or act on behalf of others
MP	Member of Parliament
MLA	Member of Legislative Assembly
Local government	Government at village, town or city level

Grassroots democracy	Participation of ordinary citizens in decisions affecting them
Public services	Services provided or supported for the benefit of people
Rule of law	The principle that everyone must follow the law

Part 6: True or False

1. Governance helps society function smoothly. — True
2. The legislature implements laws and runs the administration. — False
3. The judiciary settles disputes and interprets laws. — True
4. India has local, State and Central levels of government. — True
5. The Prime Minister is the nominal head of the Union executive. — False
6. The Chief Minister leads the State Government. — True
7. The Supreme Court is the highest court at the national level. — True
8. Democracy means the rule of one person without public participation. — False
9. In representative democracy, people elect representatives. — True
10. Indian citizens can generally register to vote from the age of 18. — True
11. Grassroots democracy encourages ordinary citizens to participate in decisions. — True
12. All three organs of government have exactly the same role. — False
13. Local governments can help deal with local problems. — True
14. Discussion and debate are important in democracy. — True
15. Government levels may cooperate during a major disaster. — True

Part 7: Multiple-Choice Questions (MCQs)

Chapter 10 Practice Test

0/18 answered

1. What is governance?

A. Only making speeches
B. Managing public affairs and making decisions
C. Only collecting taxes
D. Only conducting elections

2. Which organ makes laws?

A. Executive
B. Judiciary
C. Legislature
D. Police

3. Which organ implements laws?

A. Executive
B. Legislature
C. Judiciary
D. Election voters

4. Which organ settles legal disputes?

A. Legislature
B. Judiciary
C. Executive
D. Local market

5. What are the three levels of government in India?

A. Village, school and family
B. Local, State and Central
C. Police, army and court
D. District, school and Parliament

6. Who is the nominal head of the Union executive?

A. Prime Minister
B. Chief Justice
C. President of India
D. Chief Minister

7. Who heads the State Government?

A. Governor in day-to-day administration
B. Chief Minister
C. President of India
D. Speaker of Parliament

8. What does MP stand for?

A. Member of Parliament
B. Minister of Police
C. Main President
D. Member of Panchayat

9. What does MLA stand for?

A. Member of Local Authority
B. Member of Legislative Assembly
C. Minister of Legal Affairs
D. Main Legislative Administrator

10. What is the highest court at the national level in India?

A. District Court
B. High Court
C. Supreme Court
D. Village Court

11. What is the meaning of democracy?

A. Rule of the people
B. Rule of a king only
C. Rule without laws
D. Rule by one family

12. What is direct democracy?

A. People directly participate in a decision
B. People never vote
C. Only judges make decisions
D. Only officials discuss matters

13. What is representative democracy?

A. People elect representatives
B. Everyone must hold office
C. No elections take place
D. Only one person makes every decision

14. At what age can Indian citizens generally register to vote?

A. 16 years
B. 17 years
C. 18 years
D. 21 years

15. What does grassroots democracy encourage?

A. Silence among citizens
B. Participation of ordinary citizens
C. Control by one group
D. Avoiding local issues

16. Which level may handle a local drainage problem first?

A. Local government
B. A foreign government

C. Only Parliament
D. Only the Supreme Court

17. Why do the three organs of government have different roles?

A. To prevent misuse of power and perform different duties
B. To stop all laws
C. To avoid public services
D. To prevent elections

18. What is the main purpose of voting?

A. To choose or express a preference
B. To write laws personally
C. To settle every court case
D. To appoint every government official directly
Check Answers

Part 8: Quick Revision

Remember these key points for the examination:

- Governance is needed to manage public affairs and solve common problems.
- A government has three main organs: legislature, executive and judiciary.
- The legislature makes laws, the executive implements them and the judiciary interprets laws and settles disputes.
- India has three levels of government: local, State and Central.
- The President and Governor are the nominal heads of the Union and State executives, respectively.
- The Prime Minister and Chief Minister lead the Union and State governments in their day-to-day functioning.
- Democracy means the rule of the people.
- India is a representative democracy at the State and national levels.
- The minimum voting age in India is 18 years.
- Grassroots democracy encourages ordinary people to participate in decisions affecting their lives.

Main message of the chapter: Good governance requires clear responsibilities, cooperation among government institutions and participation by citizens. Democracy works best when people understand their rights, perform their duties and take part in public life.